RUSSELL DUDEK

ROBOTICS PRODUCT MANAGER · INTERVIEW THESIS BRIEF

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INDEPENDENT CANDIDATE BRIEF

TURN EVERY BOWL INTO A PRODUCT DECISION.

Candidate thesis
Every release should make Bowl Builder easier to trust, easier to operate, and easier to scale.

THE ACTUAL MANDATE

Install product-management leverage for a rapidly scaling engineering organization while making Bowl Builder repeatable across recipes, sites, operators, support models, and economics. Connect a multi-year roadmap, market research, competitive analysis, customer insight, detailed requirements, releases, external pilots, KPIs, and product narrative without slowing invention.

COMPANY MOMENT — LINKEDIN-REPORTED JULY 2026

30 EMPLOYEES LinkedIn-reported headcount, up 100% in six months and 500% over two years.	**73% ENGINEERING** 22 of 30 employees, making product leverage especially consequential.
200% ENGINEERING GROWTH Reported over six months and one year, increasing coordination demands.	**0.5-YEAR MEDIAN TENURE** A young shared operating memory raises the value of durable decisions.

LinkedIn figures are estimates, not internal company data. Exact product-management ownership is a discovery question.

CENTRAL OPERATING TENSIONS

Invention velocity vs. product continuity	Move quickly while preserving why a priority, requirement, release, or pilot decision was made.
Engineering scale vs. cross-functional clarity	Expand technical capacity without allowing food, customer, commercial, and operating conditions to arrive late.
Customer specificity vs. reusable product	Respect site context while extracting patterns that compound.
Throughput vs. recoverability	Protect pace while making exception and recovery learning visible.
Technical proof vs. business proof	Show that a release works and that its value and economics justify scale.

THE BOWL BUILDER PRODUCT CONTRACT

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ONE DECISION SURFACE ACROSS THE COMPLETE PRODUCT

FIVE CONTRACTS THAT MUST RECONCILE

CONTRACT	DECISION QUESTION	EXAMPLE EVIDENCE
Recipe behavior	What ingredient, environmental, food-safety, sanitation, and modification ranges produce an acceptable result?	Yield, variance, hold time, quality, allergen controls, waste.
Machine performance	What mechanical, electrical, firmware, capacity, accuracy, uptime, fault, and recovery conditions must the system meet?	Throughput, uptime, fault context, restore time, maintainability.
Order truth	How do POS input, recipe configuration, cloud services, bowl records, cameras, fleet signals, versions, and UX remain trustworthy?	Completeness, traceability, data integrity, alert quality.
Operator flow	What loading, replenishment, changeover, intervention, cleaning, training, and escalation work must be intuitive?	Touches, training, intervention, reset, adoption.
Scale economics	What labor, waste, support, utilization, business case, ROI, and pricing evidence earns expansion?	Labor hours, waste, support burden, margin, payback inputs.

DECISION RECORD — MINIMUM VIABLE FORM

OUTCOME

The result the work must improve.

ACCEPTANCE

Testable conditions across affected contracts.

EVIDENCE

Measures, units, baseline, context, exceptions.

AUTHORITY

Who recommends, decides, validates, and escalates.

ECONOMICS

Cost, labor, support, waste, utilization, pricing.

LEARNING CLOSE

Requirement, roadmap action, release decision, or next experiment.

PILOT EVIDENCE SEQUENCE

01 DECISION	02 BASELINE	03 INSTRUMENT	04 EXCEPTIONS	05 OWNERSHIP
What must become easier?	What is true before change?	What evidence is needed?	Where does the system bend?	What changes next?

EVIDENCE MAP

WHY RUSSELL DUDEK'S BACKGROUND TRANSFERS

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VERIFIED PROOF SELECTED FOR THE MANDATE

EVIDENCE	VERIFIED MECHANISM	TRANSFER TO LAB37
Vape-Jet 2025–Present	Connects approximately 1,000 fielded robots, telemetry, machine vision, support, quality, production, software issue flow, ERP, and training.	Field-to-requirement loop, product health, readiness, ownership, and fleet learning.
Amazon 2014–2018	Led Prime Pittsburgh launch, served on the Prime Now launch team with Whole Foods, and earned a Food Safety Management certification while at Amazon.	Food fulfillment, customer promise, safety awareness, high-volume flow, launch readiness, and exception response.
Compunetics 2000–2013	Led engineering, manufacturing, quality, validation, documentation, complex assemblies, customer delivery, and high-reliability programs.	Electromechanical fluency, DFM, validation, supplier handoffs, quality systems, and reliability.
DudeWorth 2017–Present	Builds AI-readiness models, agentic workflows, PRDs, user stories, acceptance criteria, review gates, decision records, and evaluation.	Ambiguity reduction, product artifacts, evidence design, and measurable iteration.
Cardinal 2021–2023	Built a regional operation and modernized customer, CRM, logistics, fulfillment, routing, and operating controls.	Distributed deployment, primary customer interface, operating economics, and commercial trade-offs.

IMMEDIATE CONTRIBUTION PROFILE

SHAPE THE ROADMAP

Connect discovery, market research, competitive analysis, strategy, dependencies, and outcomes.

RUN COMPLETE RELEASES

PRDs, user stories, acceptance criteria, success metrics, launch, and iteration.

LEAD CUSTOMER-FACING PILOTS

Serve as the primary customer interface from scope and onboarding through evidence and roadmap close.

TELL ONE COHERENT STORY

Translate product truth for engineering, executives, investors, customers, partners, and live demos.

AFFIRMATIVE RAMP PRIORITIES

Learn Lab37's architecture, firmware and cloud boundaries, culinary practice, NSF / UL and food-equipment certification landscape, release system, deployment model, market and competitive context, pricing logic, and trusted metrics—then contribute through product judgment, field evidence, launch discipline, and operating mechanisms.

INTERVIEW WORKING PAGE

ENTRY PLAN, QUESTIONS, AND DISCUSSION PROMPTS

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FIRST 90 DAYS

DAYS 1–30	DAYS 31–60	DAYS 61–90
READ THE SYSTEM Observe product, customer work, decisions, evidence, ownership, and market context.	**PROVE THE CONTRACT** Carry one pilot or release through research, requirements, readiness, customer interface, and decision close.	**MAKE LEARNING REPEATABLE** Install the smallest useful roadmap, health, pilot, and field-learning records.

EXECUTIVE INTERVIEW QUESTIONS

1. Is this the first dedicated product manager for Bowl Builder, and how is product ownership distributed today?
2. As engineering headcount expands, which decisions most need durable product memory or clearer authority?
3. How is the multi-year roadmap informed by customer discovery, market research, competitive analysis, and Atoms Food strategy?
4. What must an external pilot prove before the learning becomes reusable?
5. Who owns food-safety and NSF / UL acceptance across culinary, product, engineering, manufacturing, and the customer?
6. How are KPIs connected to the business case, ROI, pricing, and narratives for executives, investors, customers, and partners?
7. Twelve months from now, what would make this PM indispensable?

CLOSING POSITION

My product-management value is making complex work visible enough to decide. I connect customer and field truth to requirements, evidence, ownership, launch discipline, product memory, and operating cadence.

SOURCES AND EVIDENCE STATUS

Lab37 public product pages, the Robotics Product Manager job posting supplied July 2026, and a candidate-provided LinkedIn Premium company-insights snapshot dated July 2026. LinkedIn employee figures are estimates. Candidate-created models are hypotheses for discovery, not descriptions of undisclosed Lab37 process.